# Grade 7 Philippine History Lesson Plan

**Topic:** Pre-Colonial Philippines: Society, Government, Economy, and Culture
**Grade Level:** Grade 7
**Time:** 60 Minutes

**Learning Objectives**
1. Explain the characteristics of pre-colonial Philippine societies.
2. Describe the role of the barangay and the datu.
3. Identify the social classes of early Filipinos.
4. Appreciate the achievements and culture of pre-colonial Filipinos.

**Lesson Content**
Before the arrival of the Spaniards in 1521, the Philippines already had organized communities called barangays. A barangay was composed of families led by a datu. These communities had their own laws, traditions, and systems of government.

The datu served as the political leader, judge, and military commander. Barangays traded with neighboring communities and foreign merchants from China, India, and Southeast Asia.

**Lesson Proper**

**Social Structure of Pre-Colonial Society**
**Maharlika** – The noble class and warriors. **Timawa** – The freemen who owned property and could serve in the community. **Alipin** – Individuals who rendered service to others because of debt or obligation. **Economic Activities**
Early Filipinos engaged in: Farming (rice, coconuts, root crops) Fishing Hunting Trading with local and foreign merchants **Culture and Beliefs**
Early Filipinos practiced animism, believing that spirits lived in nature. Community rituals were often led by a babaylan or catalonan. Music, dancing, weaving, tattooing, and oral literature were important parts of daily life.

**Assessment and Evaluation**

**Class Activity:**
Create a concept map showing the government, economy, and social structure of a pre-colonial barangay.

**Quiz**
1. What was the basic political unit in pre-colonial Philippines?
2. Who was the leader of the barangay?
3. Name the three social classes in pre-colonial society.
4. What economic activities did early Filipinos practice?
5. What is animism?
6. Who led religious rituals in many communities?
7. Why was trade important to early Filipinos?
8. What role did the datu play in society?
9. Give one example of pre-colonial Filipino culture.
10. Why is it important to study pre-colonial Philippine history?

**Assignment**
Research one pre-colonial kingdom such as Butuan, Tondo, or Sulu and write a one-page report about its government, economy, and culture.

**Reflection**
Understanding pre-colonial Philippine history helps students appreciate that Filipinos already had thriving communities, rich cultures, and systems of governance before colonization.